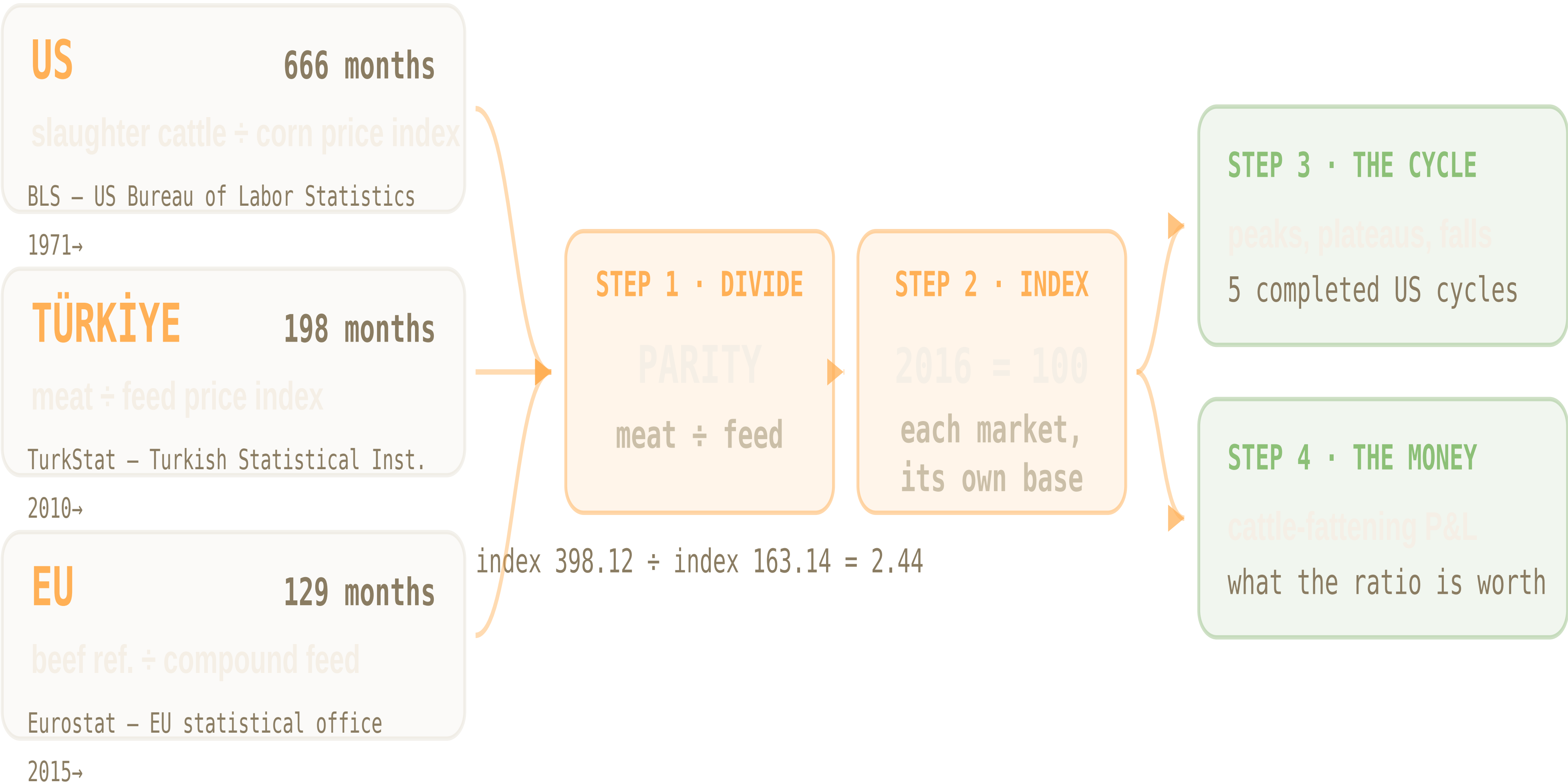
1 · WHAT THIS STUDY IS · JULY 2026

55 years of US data. 16 of Türkiye. 11 of the EU.

Six published price series — every monthly observation each country has — consolidated into one comparable measure of what a livestock producer earns, then read for its cycle.



EVERY FIGURE IS AN OFFICIAL PUBLISHED PRICE · NOTHING ESTIMATED OR FILLED IN BY US · DATA THROUGH JUNE 2026

Cattle producers in all three of our markets are at a cycle peak.

+84% US +25% EU +21% TR

more feed a kilo of beef buys today than it did in 2016 — each market against its own past

13

months the US has already spent within 10% of its peak

0

of the five previous US peaks that lasted — every one fell back

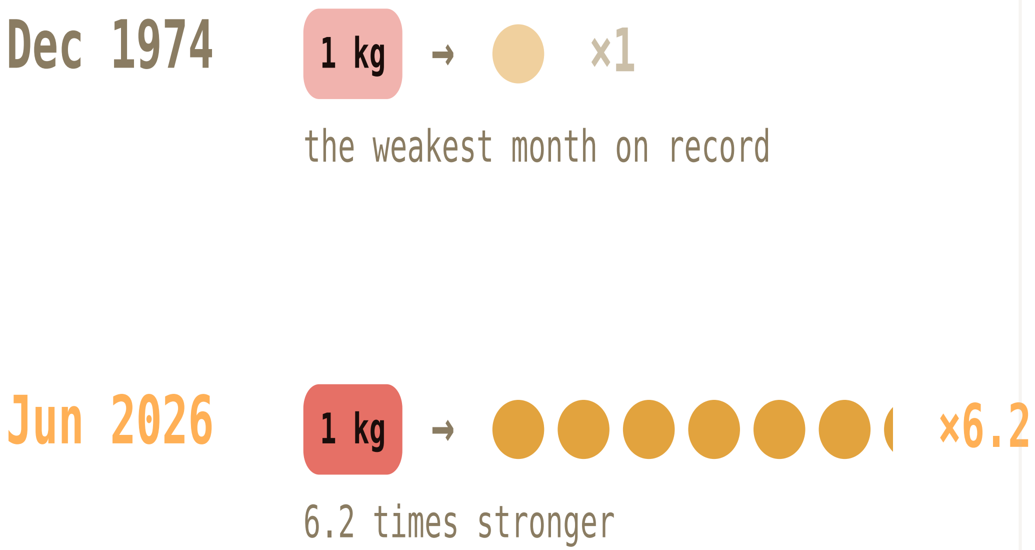
MEAT PRICE ÷ FEED COST · SOURCES: BLS (US), EUROSTAT (EU), TURKSTAT (TÜRKİYE) · DATA THROUGH JUNE 2026

3 · WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT

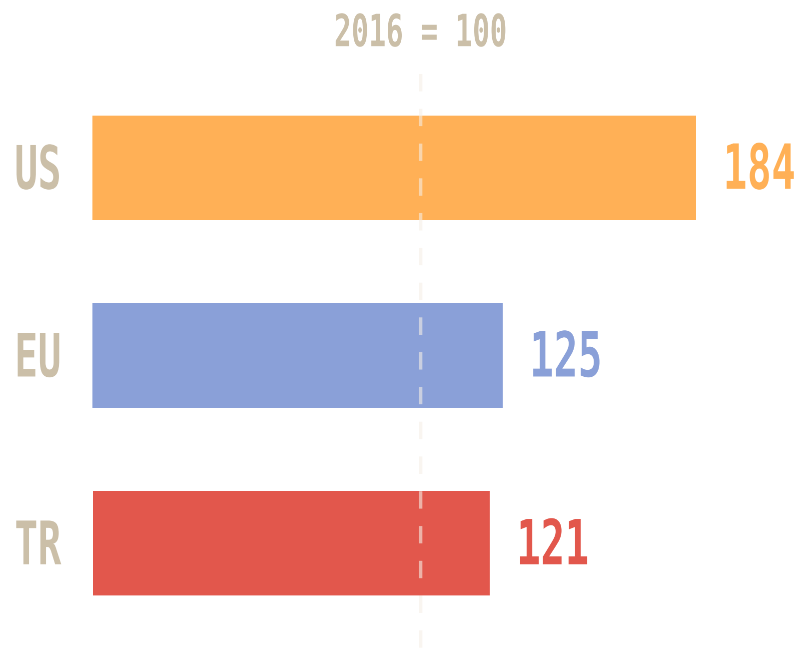
One ratio: what a kilo of beef is worth in feed.

Higher = meat outpacing feed, the producer earns more. **It is a relative measure — read it against its own past, never as a quantity of feed.**

FEED-BUYING POWER OF A KILO OF US BEEF



ALL THREE MARKETS · EACH VS ITS OWN 2016



US 184 = 84% more feed per kilo of beef than in 2016.

each oval = the Dec 1974 low · ratio of US cattle and corn producer price indexes

Same-market change is comparable; raw price levels are

US **slaughter cattle ÷ corn**
BLS (US federal statistics office) · 1971→ · 666 mo

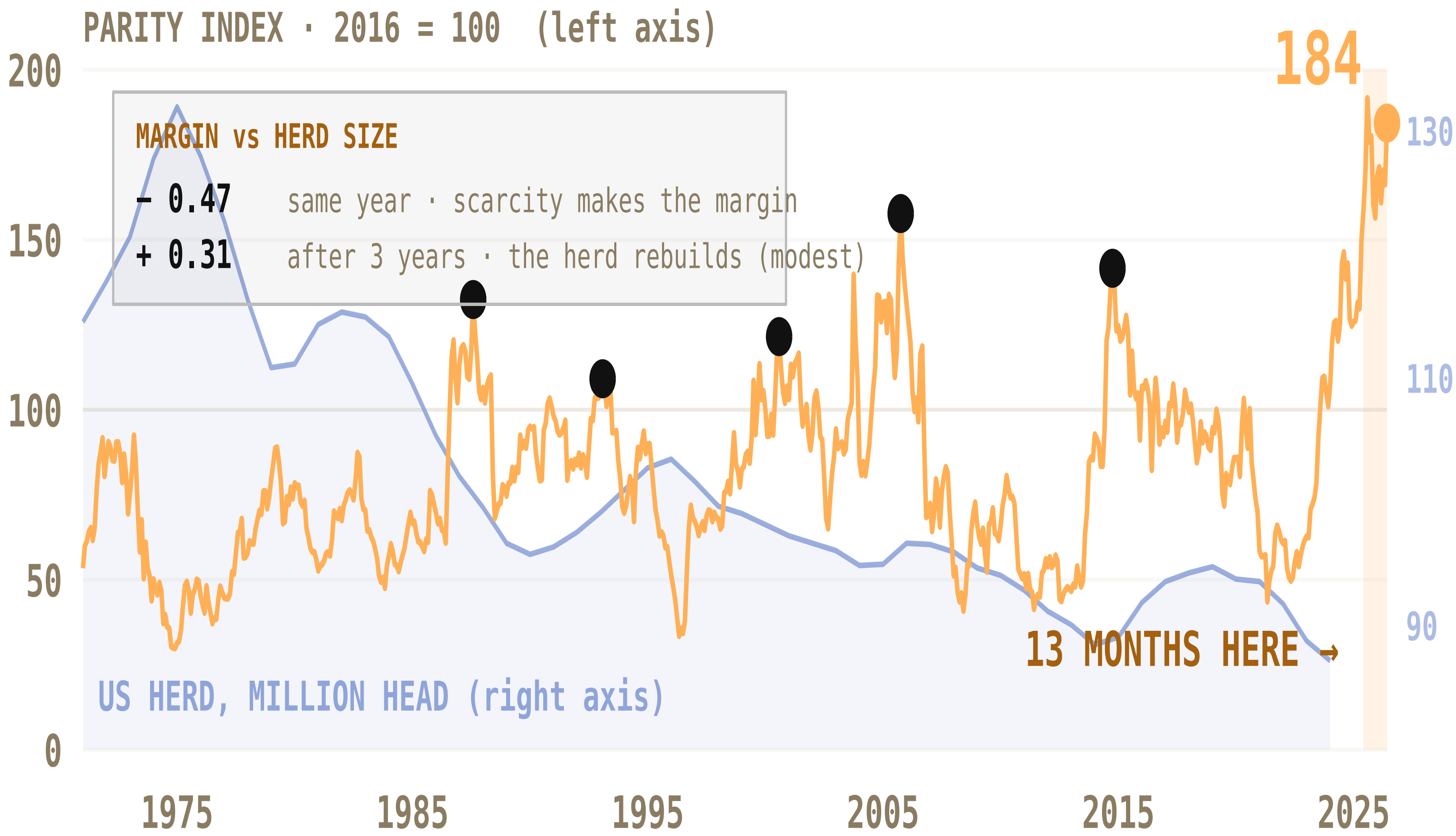
EU **beef ref. price ÷ compound feed**
Eurostat · 2015→ · 129 mo

TR **meat ÷ feed PPI**
TurkStat · 2010→ · 198 mo

Not the same basket in each country — which is why each series is indexed to its own base, and why we read shape rather than level.

Record margins. Fewest cattle since the series began.

US only. Amber = producer margin ratio (left). Blue = the size of the US cattle herd (right). Scarcity is what makes the margin.

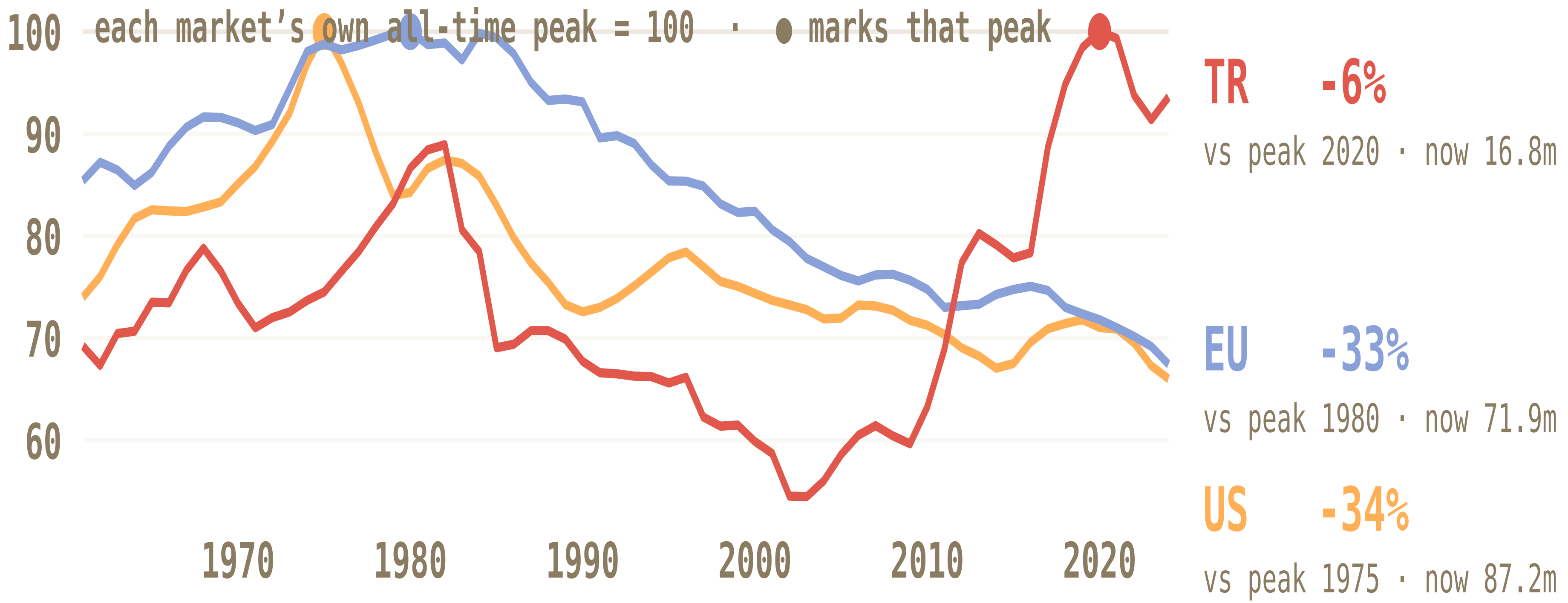


PARITY: MONTHLY, 2016 = 100 · HERD: FAOSTAT, ANNUAL · DOTS = PREVIOUS CYCLE PEAKS · 84% OF THE RATIO'S MOVEMENT COMES FROM FEED

5 · HOW MANY CUSTOMERS · US · EU · TÜRKİYE

Two herds down a third. One still growing.

Cattle numbers, each market against its own all-time peak. **Margin is measured per animal — this is how many animals there are.**



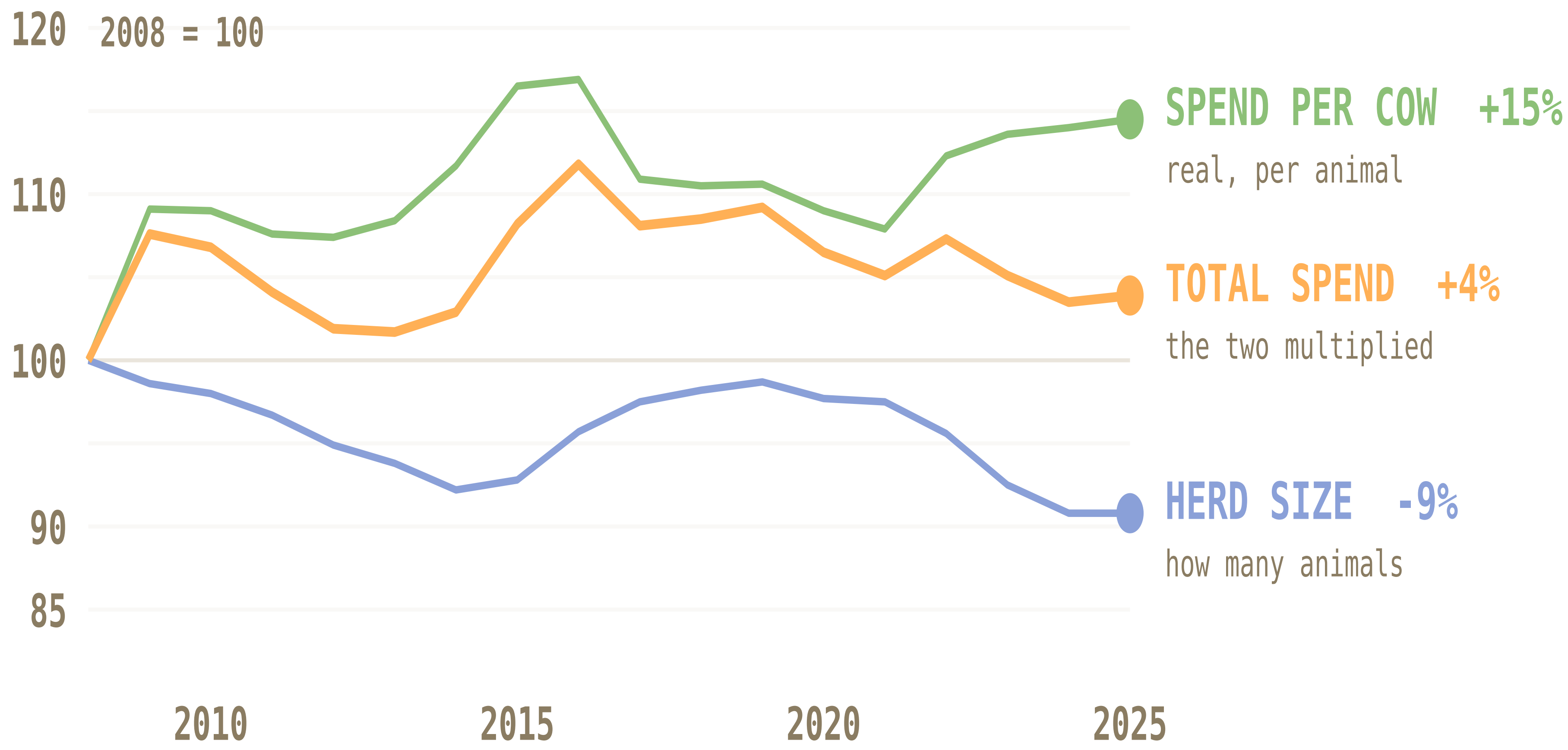
These counts include dairy and beef animals together — FAOSTAT reports all cattle. Parity, by contrast, is a beef measure throughout. That matters most for the EU, where a large part of the decline is dairy restructuring (fewer, higher-yielding cows, accelerating after quotas ended in 2015) rather than the beef cycle. The US herd is predominantly beef, so its line is the closest match to the parity line. Series ends 2024; FAOSTAT publishes with roughly an 18-month lag.

FAOSTAT CATTLE STOCKS, ANNUAL, 1961–2024 · EACH SERIES INDEXED TO ITS OWN PEAK YEAR = 100 · DAIRY AND BEEF COMBINED

6 · DOES THE SPEND FOLLOW? · UNITED STATES

More per animal. Fewer animals. Total flat.

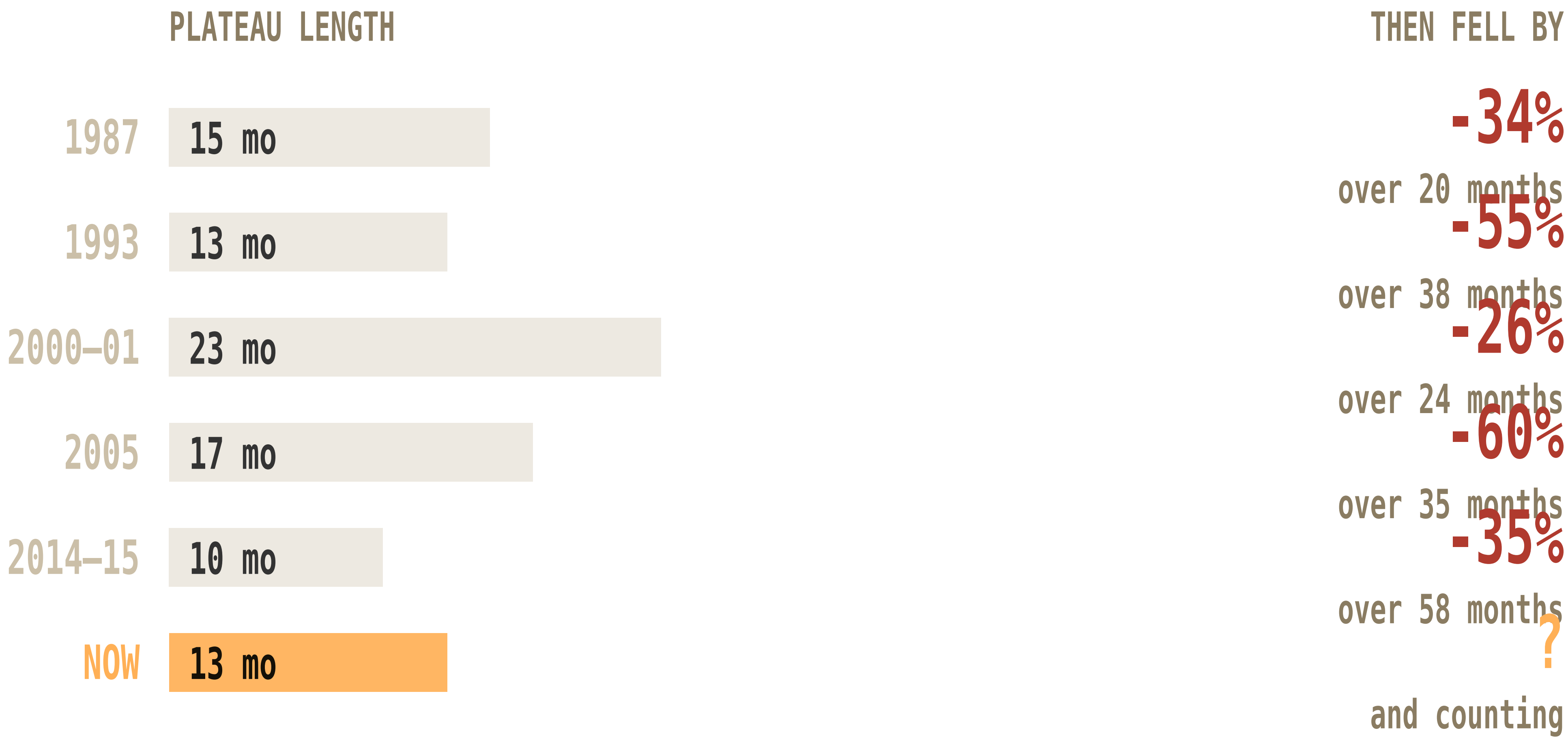
US cow-calf vet & medicine spending, inflation-adjusted. **Per animal it rises with the margin (r = +0.70) — the shrinking herd cancels it out.**



USDA ERS COW-CALF COSTS, US TOTAL · 2008 = 100, REAL 2025 DOLLARS · STARTS 2008: ERS CHANGED SURVEY BASIS THAT YEAR

Five US peaks. Every one fell 25–60% — over two to five years.

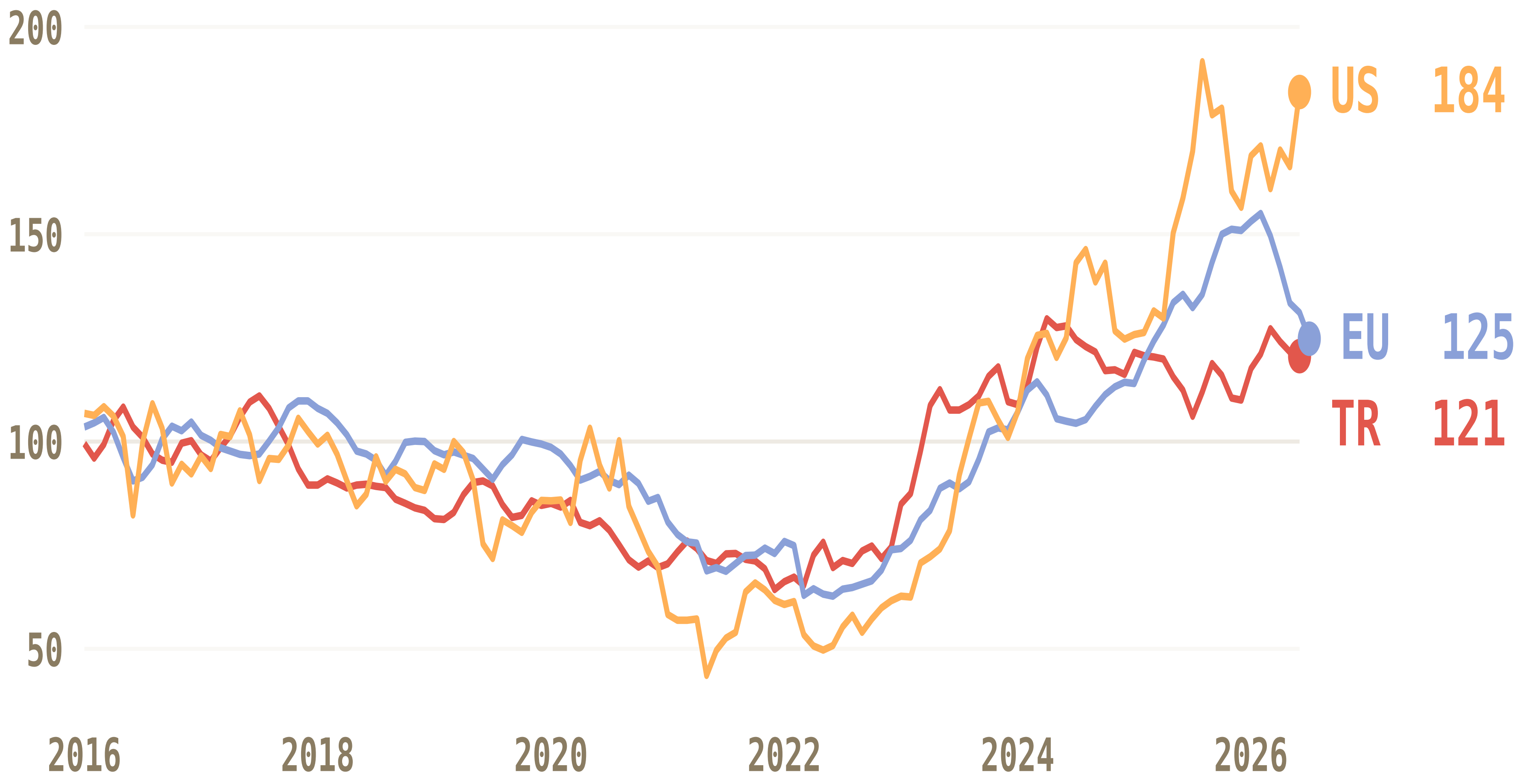
US cycles, 1971–2026 — the only record long enough to count them. **Peaks and falls measured on the twelve-month average, so single-month spikes do not count as cycles.**



TWELVE-MONTH AVERAGE · PLATEAU = MONTHS WITHIN 10% OF PEAK · FALL = PEAK TO THE NEXT LOW · A CYCLE PEAK IS A LOCAL MAXIMUM OVER ±18 MONTHS

Three markets. One cycle. At the same time.

Now all three — each on its own 2016 = 100 base. **Watch the shape, not the gap: levels are not comparable, timing is.** The last year diverges — the US is still climbing while the EU cools — because each herd rebuilds on its own schedule.

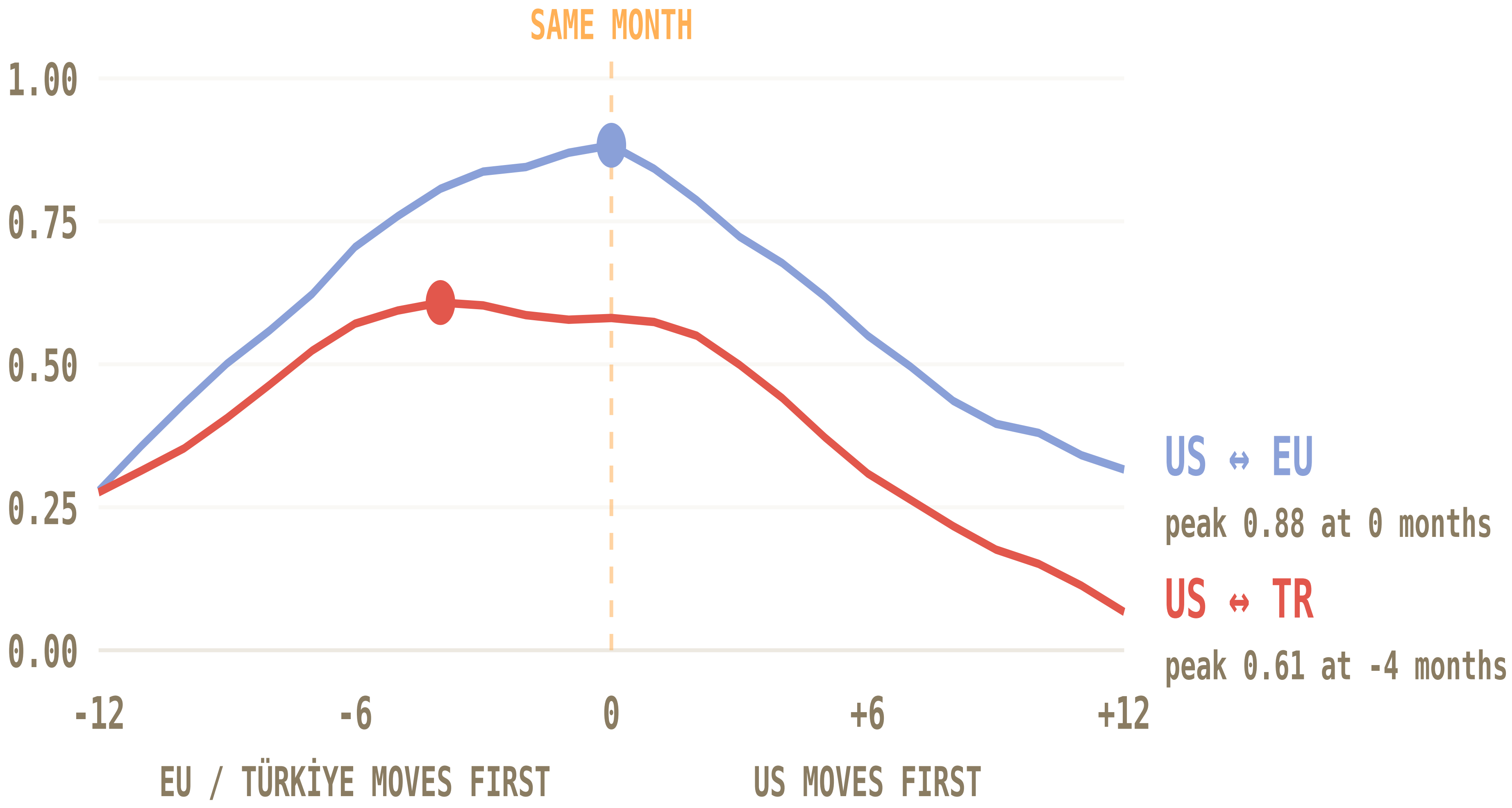


EACH MARKET INDEXED TO ITS OWN 2016 AVERAGE = 100 · CHART STARTS 2016: FIRST YEAR ALL THREE SERIES EXIST · EU IS THE 27-MEMBER AGGREGATE, NOT ANY ONE COUNTRY

9 · ARE THEY REALLY THE SAME CYCLE?

Yes — and nobody goes first, so there is no early warning.

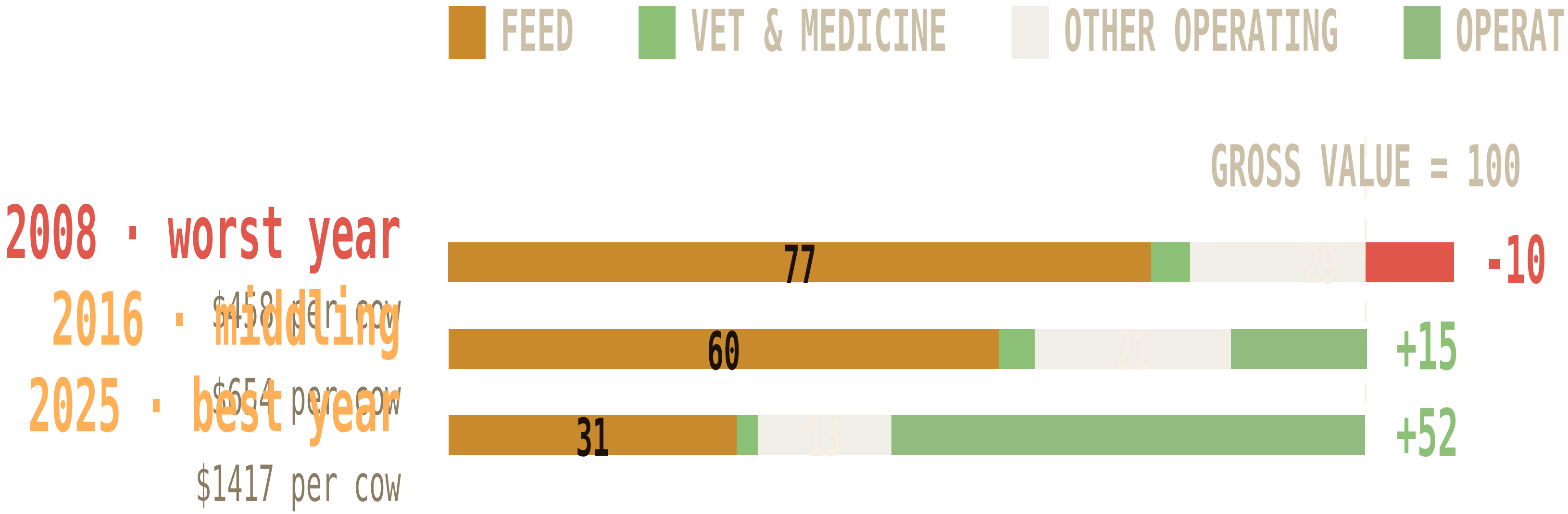
Correlation of year-on-year change, tested at every shift from −12 to +12 months. A market that led would peak clearly off-centre. The EU peaks exactly at zero; Türkiye is flat across −4 to 0.



IF ONE MARKET LED, WE COULD WATCH IT AND PREPARE THE OTHERS. IT DOES NOT. · PEARSON CORRELATION ON YEAR-ON-YEAR CHANGE · US–EU 116 OVERLAPPING MONTHS · US–TÜRKİYE 186

Feed was 77% of revenue. Now it is 31%.

USDA's own cow-calf accounts, per $100 of gross value. **Nothing modelled — these are surveyed costs. The feed line does the swinging; vet spend barely moves.**



Operating margin, not profit — excludes overhead, unpaid family labour and capital recovery (USDA costs these at ~¾ of gross value). Cow-calf, not feedlot, so no calf-purchase line.

EVERY SOURCE IN THIS DECK

Meat & feed prices

US: BLS producer price indexes WPU0131 (slaughter cattle) ÷ WPU012202 (corn), via FRED, 1971→
EU: European Commission beef reference price ÷ feed grain, 2015→
Türkiye: TurkStat Yİ-ÜFE TP.TUFE1YI.T17 ÷ T25, via CBRT EVDS, 2010→

Cattle numbers

FAOSTAT cattle stocks (head), via Our World in Data, 1961–2024, all three markets

Veterinary spend

US: USDA ERS commodity costs and returns, cow-calf, 1996→
EU: Eurostat Economic Accounts for Agriculture, item AM205000, 2005→

Deflators

US: CPI-U (FRED CPIAUCSL) · Euro area: HICP (FRED CP0000EZ19M086NEST)

Breaks & limits

ERS changed survey basis in 2008 — no comparison spans it. EU veterinary line covers all livestock, not cattle alone. No per-head cost accounts published for Türkiye.

All series fetched automatically and committed to the repository — every figure in this deck is reproducible from data/*.json. Data through June 2026.

Six numbers. Each one checkable.

Each one reproducible from the committed data files. Three describe where we are; three describe what it does to us.

184

US margin at a 55-year record

2016 = 100. The twelve highest months in the whole series have all fallen since June 2025.

0 of 5

previous US peaks that held

Every one reversed — 25 to 60%, over two to five years. Five observations: a pattern, not a law.

0.88

US–EU correlation at zero lag

One global cycle with no leader and no follower, so there is no early-warning market to watch.

−34% / −33%

US and EU herds below their peaks

Scarcity is what makes the margin: parity and herd size correlate −0.47 in the same year.

+0.70

US spend per head vs producer margin

The strongest relationship in the study. In the EU the same measure is flat — no cycle response at all.

+4%

the real US pool, in seventeen years

Spend per head +15%, herd −9%. More per animal, fewer animals, and the two nearly cancel.

Three markets. Three different instructions.

Same cycle everywhere, three different consequences. The US is a timing problem. The EU is a volume problem. Türkiye is a visibility problem.

US

HOW MANY ANIMALS

-34%

vs peak · now 87m · bottom 2024

SPEND vs MARGIN cyclical

r = 0.70

THE MONEY IN THE MARKET

+4% 17-yr real pool

TIME THE PRICE MOVE

2027 points up: the record margin still feeds spend per head, and the herd is bottoming. Phase the increase before the plateau breaks.

EU

HOW MANY ANIMALS

-33%

vs peak · now 72m · -1.4%/yr

SPEND vs MARGIN flat

r = 0.00

THE MONEY IN THE MARKET

-5% 20-yr real pool

DEFEND THE VOLUME

2027 is not a bad year — it is the same year, ~1.5% smaller. No cycle upside, no cycle hit; the herd erodes regardless.

TÜRKİYE

HOW MANY ANIMALS

-6%

vs peak · now 17m · +2.4% 2024

SPEND vs MARGIN no data

–

THE MONEY IN THE MARKET

n/a not measurable

GROW, AND GET VISIBILITY

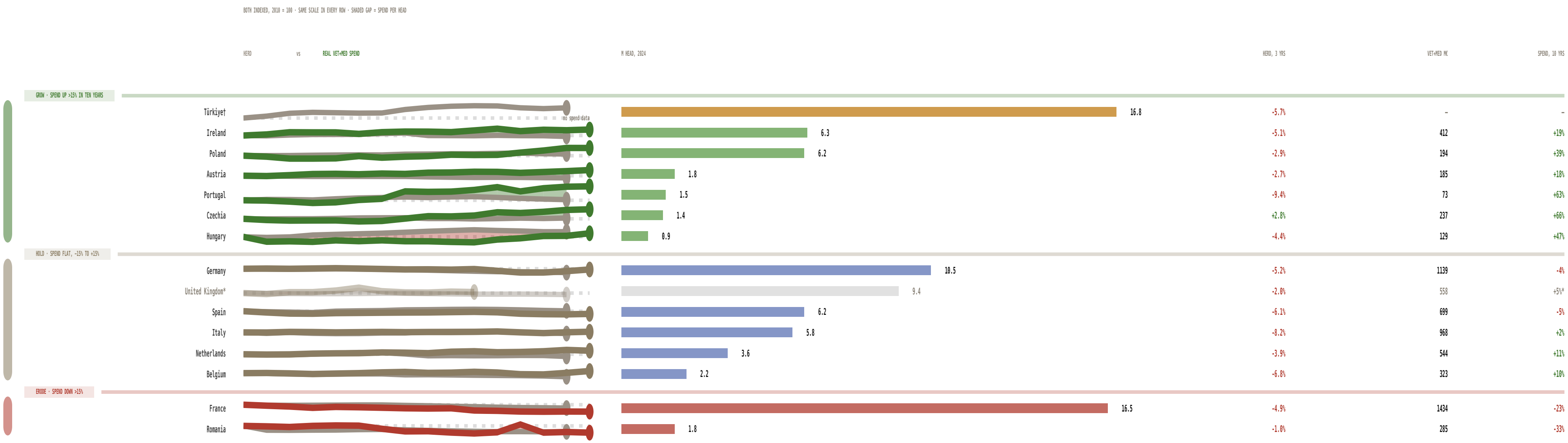
2027 is the only market where head count adds to volume — and the only one where we cannot see what producers spend.

What I am asking for: two to three weeks with the livestock commercial teams — map our cattle-segment sales in the CEEME markets through the last two downturns against this ratio, and rank that portfolio by what a producer defers first. **What I need from you is an introduction to the livestock lead.**

HERD: FAOSTAT · SPEND SENSITIVITY = CORRELATION OF REAL VET SPEND PER HEAD WITH PRODUCER MARGIN · NO PER-HEAD COSTS PUBLISHED FOR TR

Every herd is shrinking. Only the spending separates them.

Per country, two lines on one scale: the herd and real vet+med spend, each indexed to 100 in 2010. The gap between them is spend per head. Fourteen of the fifteen herds are smaller than three years ago — only Czechia grew, and Hungary, Poland and Czechia did all their ten-year growth before 2020. No volume growth is available anywhere in 2027 — but in six markets the green line still climbs away from the grey.



The 2027 price call. Every herd here is contracting, so the increase comes from price and spend per head, not volume. **Grow — Czechia, Portugal, Hungary, Poland, Ireland, Austria:** real spend rose +18% to +66% while herds tightened. Take the full increase. **But size the prize honestly:** those six are **19% of EU vet+med spend — France alone is bigger than all six combined**, which is why the EU verdict on slide 12 is still defend. **Hold — Germany, Netherlands, Belgium, Italy, Spain:** spend steady, herds not. Price carries the number. **Erode — France, Romania:** −23% and −33%. Defend share, do not lead on price. **Türkiye is not an EU market** and is not in the Eurostat accounts — largest herd on the page, the only decade of herd growth, no spend series at all. Grow it, and get the visibility. **United States (slides 4–7):** record margin absorbs price — front-load to January, keep 2028 flexible.

HERD: FAOSTAT, ALL CATTLE, DAIRY+BEEF, ANNUAL TO 2024 · SPEND: EUROSTAT EAA "VETERINARY EXPENSES" = VET SERVICES + MEDICINES, ALL LIVESTOCK NOT CATTLE ALONE, TO 2025 · BOTH LINES INDEXED TO 100 IN 2010; EVERY ROW USES THE SAME INDEX-POINTS-PER-PIXEL (84 POINTS FULL HEIGHT) BUT IS CENTRED ON ITS OWN DATA, SO SLOPES ARE COMPARABLE ACROSS ROWS; DOTTED LINE = 100, DOT = LATEST YEAR; SHADED GAP = REAL SPEND PER HEAD, GREEN WHERE SPEND OUTRUNS THE HERD · SPEND DEFLATED BY EURO-AREA HICP (APPROX. FOR NON-EURO PL/RO/CZ/HU) · HERD 3 YRS = 2021→2024, SAME SIGN ON A 5-YEAR WINDOW FOR ALL FIFTEEN · A 3-YEAR REAL SPEND FIGURE IS NOT SHOWN: THE 2022–23 INFLATION SPIKE FLIPS ITS SIGN WITH THE BASE YEAR · SHARE-OF-SPEND WEIGHTS FROM 2025 LEVELS, 13 MEMBER STATES, UK EXCLUDED · *UK SPEND SERIES ENDS 2020 · †NO SPEND SOURCE FOR TÜRKİYE · THE 13 EU MEMBER-STATE ROWS = 90% OF THE EU27 HERD; UK AND TÜRKİYE ARE NOT EU AND ARE EXCLUDED FROM EVERY EU TOTAL · US IS ON A DIFFERENT SPEND SOURCE (USDA ERS, $/COW) AND IS NOT COMPARABLE HERE